



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's review!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- What are some social behaviors that are acceptable in your culture?
- What are some social behaviors that are unacceptable in your culture?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about what is acceptable and unacceptable.
- I can deal with a communication breakdown.
- I can show interest and enthusiasm in conversations.





Let's Explore!

Peter and Ferdinand talk about what is acceptable and unacceptable in South American culture.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Hey Ferdinand, aren't you Latino? You're never early! What do you mean by arriving at the bar before me?
- Ferdinand:** I'm not sure I follow you. Miranda said North Americans usually arrive ten minutes before the agreed time. I am making a point of practising punctuality.
- Peter:** Really? You sure are keen. I'm inspired at your efforts. A pat on the back to you, but don't let work affect your social life!
- Ferdinand:** Whatever it takes. But do you mean that it is unusual for North Americans to arrive early to social events?
- Peter:** Some people do. It's not inappropriate. It is acceptable to be a little late for an informal gathering. However, it could be inconsiderate to keep someone waiting for long if it's just the two of you.
- Ferdinand:** Like when? I don't get it.
- Peter:** Well don't be late if you're meeting a woman. Believe me, she'll worry you've stood her up and be embarrassed. Also, you run the risk of another guy picking her up.
- Ferdinand:** I'll keep that in mind.
- Peter:** Hey, I think you did great with impressing Janet.
- Ferdinand:** How so?
- Peter:** She's commissioned you as their main PR guy in South America. Is that true?
- Ferdinand:** Yes, along with some guy named Rocco. Do you know him?
- Peter:** Nice old guy. More on him later - here comes the waiter.



Let's Practice!

Sorry, Ferdinand, can you repeat that please*?

**Remember, this is a way to ask for clarification.*

Instructions: Match the two parts of the sentences from Column A to Column B.

COLUMN A

How
Like when?
What do you
But do
I'm not sure

COLUMN B

mean by arriving at the bar before me?
you mean that it is unusual for North
Americans to arrive early?
I don't get it.
so?
I follow you.



Let's Practice!

What does Peter tell Ferdinand?

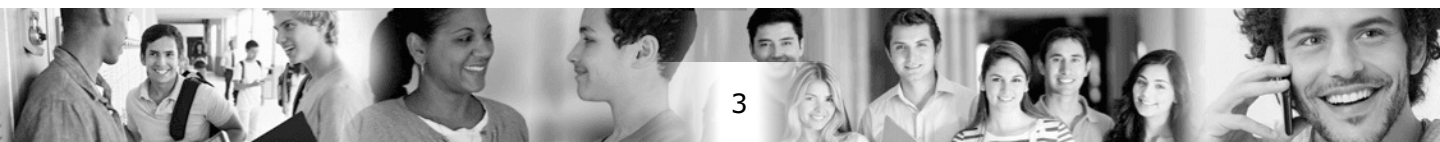
Instructions: Organize the mystery words. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1) North / the / before / usually / arrive / Americans / agreed / ten / time. / minutes

2) ? / early / to / Is / not / events / unusual / Americans / up / social / to / inappropriate. / show / It's / it / for / North

3) late / acceptable / be / for / little / is / to / a / It / an / gathering. / informal

4) keep / if / you. / long / be / of / to / someone / consider / the / to / for / inconsiderate / it / North / Americans / just / waiting / two / it's





Extension Activity

Let's talk about cultural differences.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make a list of customs that are both acceptable and unacceptable in your culture.
- Pick a culture that is different from your own and research that culture's customs online.
- Which customs are similar to your own culture's? Which are different? Fill out the table below.
- Share your findings with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I understand acceptable and unacceptable customs in my culture.

☐ ☐

I read about a culture different from my own.

☐ ☐

I understand the differences and similarities between customs in my culture and another culture.

☐ ☐

Similar

Different



Target Words

- keen** (adjective): eager or wanting to do something
e.g. You sure are keen.
- pat on the back** (expression): to give praise and appreciation
e.g. A pat on the back to you - but we aren't on the job!
- whatever it takes** (expression): doing anything that is necessary in order to achieve a goal
e.g. You need to do whatever it takes to succeed.
- to commission** (verb): to ask or hire someone to do something for you
e.g. She's going to commission you as their main PR guy.
- run the risk** (expression): allowing the chance for harm or loss
e.g. You run the risk of another guy picking up your date if you're late.
- inspired** (adjective): filled with the motivation or ability to do something positive
e.g. I'm inspired at your efforts.



Learning Points

Talking About What Is Acceptable And Unacceptable

In the business world, there's a close connection between culture and social behavior. Different cultures have different patterns of social behavior. What might be acceptable in some cultures may be perceived as being acceptable or unacceptable.

Passive Voice In Present Structure	Examples
Subject + Simple Present tense + Past Participle + Rest of sentence	→ North Americans are expected to be on time. → Feelings are expressed more openly in South America.

Other phrases you can use to talk about what is acceptable or unacceptable:

- *Is it unusual for people to show up early to social events?*
- *It's not inappropriate to do something like that.*
- *It is acceptable to be a little late for an informal gathering.*





Learning Points

Showing Interest and Enthusiasm

Remember, in order to keep a conversation going, you need to make sure you show the speaker that you are listening to what is being said.

Below you will find useful ways to be an active listener and keep the conversation going. The "good news" is that you actually don't need many words in order to do this.

Showing Interest

- Excellent!
- Really? (*with a rising intonation*)
- Is that so?
- Terrific!
- I'm looking forward to ... (*use '-ing'*)
- I think you did a nice/great job on/with ...

Ask a short question.

Use an auxiliary verb to ask a short question which will prompt the speaker to continue talking.

- I'm going away next week .→ Oh, are you?
- I heard you're going to South America. → Is that true?
- I finished the report. → Did you?

Examples:

• **Jane:** *I am making a point of practising punctuality.*

Shawn: *Is that so?*

• **Jane:** *Yes. Sue got the e-mail today.*

• **Shawn:** *Is that true?*

